

Data Handling and Classification Policy

Version 3.2 · Owner: IT Department · Review: annually

1. Purpose

This policy explains how company and customer information must be classified, shared, kept and disposed of.

2. Classification levels

All information is classified as Public, Internal, Confidential or Restricted. Public information may be shared freely. Internal information is for staff only. Confidential information includes customer data and contracts. Restricted information includes payment data, passwords and security keys.

3. Sharing

Confidential information must not be emailed outside the company unless it is encrypted. Restricted information must never be emailed. Use the approved file-sharing service for external transfers.

4. AI tools

Customer data, Confidential and Restricted information must never be pasted into public AI tools. Only the AI tools on the approved list in the company portal may be used with Internal information.

5. Retention

Support tickets are kept for 3 years. System and security logs are kept for 1 year. Contracts are kept for 7 years after they end. Information is deleted when its retention period ends.

6. Disposal

Paper containing Confidential or Restricted information goes in the locked shredding bins. Laptops, disks and other media are wiped and disposed of by IT; never throw them away yourself.